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LING 612

Dr. Hartshorn

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Feedback 2

Context

I observed a video of Shantu, and she did a great job! The first time I've observed her teaching was when we watched her video recording in class, so I was excited to observe her teaching! Some context for this community class is that the students are in Level 2, and from what I've heard, there are many Spanish speakers and maybe one or two Russian speakers. Shantu would sometimes use Spanish as she is also learning it, and I loved how this encouraged multilingualism in the classroom. It looked like Shantu was teaching the first portion of class because she spent the first part of class reviewing past content they learned like the difference between Ms. And Mrs., the names of colors, and the correct use of demonstratives.

Class Layout

After the review, the students completed a few activities in the book. The instruction Shantu gave differed between class discussions, individual work, and pair work, which helped the class to move quickly and differentiate the delivery of content. The activities consisted of looking at pictures and deciphering what was happening in the image, discussing hair colors, and working on a worksheet with three questions to discuss with a partner.

Strengths and Weaknesses

Shantu has many strengths, and that is apparent in this video! First, she has fun energy! She loves to smile, laugh and joke, and I noticed that the students were more vocal and energetic in class. I loved observing the unique things that Shantu and the other teachers do with their students. One example is the “one-clap” tradition; I noticed that Shantu would do this for fun; I think she also used it to make sure the students were paying attention, and I liked that she did this! They would usually do it twice, which was a wonderful way to encourage the students to participate if they missed the cue the first time.

Another strength of Shantu’s is that she can work on the fly. I noticed that there were many times where she would look at the things around her and use them as examples in her teaching. One example is when she would use realia in the classroom (e.g., a student’s hair color) to teach about different colors. I loved how she used the students in the classroom to help them feel seen, noticed, and special. Another example of working on the fly was when she would be teaching a concept and take time for learning vocabulary. It looked like she was asked questions by students about vocabulary, sensed a need, or wanted students to understand something that would help them be successful in understanding the content she was teaching.

Another strength of Shantu’s is that she has no fears of being herself, which allows her to do many things as a teacher because she is not afraid of keeping up an appearance. It also helps her to be more relatable and personable to her students, creating a comfortable environment for her students. I noticed that this strength helps her students to be more participative in class; I also observed that Shantu’s personality helped infuse confidence into her students so that they were not afraid to make mistakes in their language production. One clear way that she would do this was through working one-on-one with students. I loved this! It helped her to have an individual relationship with her students as she helped them through answering questions and cheering for

them when they had the right answer. Another way that Shantu helped her students to gain confidence in their abilities was through guiding her students to produce in the language by saying statements and leaving silence/blanks for her students to fill in the blank with the correct answer.

Suggestions for Changes

I have very few suggestions of things to do differently because Shantu did a great job! I could see that she cares about her students, and she has incredible skills in how to help her students to understand what she was teaching. One suggestion I would give is regarding the review. I loved how much time Shantu took on the review! I think that this helped the students start class feeling stable and secure in their knowledge so that they could build upon it with the new content they were learning. Since this was review, I wonder if the review content could have been structured more with asking comprehension questions to draw the answers from the students. Shantu did a great job of this in the first activity where she had the students look at a picture and asked them questions about things that they saw. I loved when she did this, and I think it could also be powerful to structure the review in this way!

A last suggestion I have is regarding giving instructions on activities. I think that something that could be helpful is providing an example demonstration first before having the students work on the activity by themselves or with a partner. I liked that Shantu would give the instructions then went around to each group or student to have one-on-one time with them to guide them on the activity. I think that if she combined a demonstration with the one-on-one interactions and instruction, that could be really powerful!

Last Observations

Shantu is a good teacher! I hope she knows that. I learned a lot from watching her video recording. She knows what she is doing, and she provides a unique aspect to teaching English having learned it herself that I cannot provide being a native English speaker. One example was when she was instructing her students to turn the page in their book, and she completed the action of doing it and explained why they say “turn.” I thought this was fascinating, and I do not think I would have recognized how idiomatic this phrase is unless a student asked me for its meaning. Shantu is very perceptive, and she recognizes where her students are coming from having been in their place already. Lastly, I have applied certain principles I observed in Shantu in my own teaching! One example is when I was leading a review section of our class. During this review, I remembered when Shantu encouraged her students to practice spelling English words, so I had my students do this! It worked really well, and it pushed them. I love Shantu! I am so grateful for her example and friendship to me.